

1672

DUTCH “DISASTER YEAR”

From 1650, the Netherlands flourished under the leadership of the brothers Johan and Cornelis de Witt but in 1672 was invaded by Louis XIV’s France with naval support from England. The de Witts, blamed for military failure, were lynched by a mob. William of Orange took over as ruler and blocked the French advance by opening the dikes to flood low-lying areas. The Netherlands survived the “Rampjaar” (“Disaster Year”), but the Dutch Golden Age had ended.



◀ The de Witt brothers



1673

REVOLT OF THE THREE FEUDATORIES

The Manchu Qing dynasty faced a major revolt in southern China. Han Chinese generals who had supported the Manchu takeover had been given provinces to rule as personal fiefdoms. Three of these “feudatories” – Wu Sangui in Yunnan province, Shang Zhixin in Guangdong, and Geng Jingzhong in Fujian – rebelled and threatened to overthrow the Manchu Kangxi Emperor. It took eight years of military campaigns to suppress the revolt and finally render Qing dynasty rule in China secure.

◀ Wu Sangui

1675 Mughal Emperor Aurangzeb has the Sikh leader Tegh Bahadur executed

1679

1678 The treaties signed at the Peace of Nijmegen end the war between France and the Dutch Republic

1674

RISE OF THE MARATHA EMPIRE

The Marathas were Hindu warrior clans living in southern India. From the 1640s, Shivaji, a member of the Bhonsle clan, proved a formidable military leader. Forced to accept the overlordship of Mughal emperor Aurangzeb in 1665, he soon resumed his campaigns and in 1674 was crowned Maratha emperor. By Shivaji’s death in 1680 he controlled a swathe of southern India. Surviving Aurangzeb’s counter-attacks, the Maratha empire flourished in the following century.



◀ Statue of Shivaji Bhonsle